

CuddleNine

Little Care, Big Love

Complete 0–12 Months Baby Care Guide

A practical, step-by-step handbook for new parents.
What to do, what to feed, what to apply — every month clearly explained.

First 24 Hours Guide	0–12 Month Feeding Plan
Monthly Sleep Schedules	Skincare & Hygiene Tips
Vaccination Chart	Red Flags & Emergencies
5 Printable Checklists	Parent Wellness Notes

© CuddleNine · Educational purposes only · Always consult your pediatrician

Table of Contents

01	First 24 Hours — Hour-by-Hour Guide	3
02	Month 1 (0–30 Days) — Adjustment	5
03	Month 2 — The Smile Month	6
04	Month 3 — Communication	7
05	Month 4 — Rolling Over	8
06	Month 5 — Grasping	9
07	Month 6 — Solids Begin!	10
08	Month 7 — Real Food Taste	11
09	Month 8 — Crawling	12
10	Month 9 — Standing Ready	13
11	Month 10 — First Steps	14
12	Month 11 — Walking Practice	15
13	Month 12 — Happy Birthday!	16
14	Vaccination Chart	17
15	Red Flags — When to Call Doctor	18
16	Bonus Printable Checklists	19

Chapter 1 · First 24 Hours — Hour by Hour

The most important window for new parents. Follow this timeline carefully for feeding, care, and safety.

Hours 0–2 · Right After Birth

- Place baby skin-to-skin on mother's chest immediately
- Start breastfeeding within the first hour (colostrum is pure gold)
- Do NOT apply powder, oil, or lotion — keep skin plain
- Only wipe gently with soft cotton cloth

Hours 2–6

- First stool is black-green meconium — completely normal
- Nurse measures weight, length, head size
- Keep umbilical cord stump dry — no oil or powder
- Feed every 2 hours even if baby is sleeping (wake if needed)

Hours 6–12

- First urine should appear within 24 hours
- Dress baby in cap + mittens + socks to prevent heat loss
- Change diapers every 2–3 hours
- Avoid wet wipes — use cotton + lukewarm water only
- No water to drink — only breast milk or formula

Hours 12–24

- Watch for mild jaundice (yellow tint) — get checked if concerned
- Only sponge bath until cord falls off — no full tub bath
- Mother's milk comes in — breasts may feel full; warm compress helps
- 8–12 feeds in 24 hours is normal — feed on demand

Red Flags — Call Doctor Immediately

- Difficulty breathing or unusual breathing sounds
- Temperature below 97°F or above 99.5°F
- No feed for 4+ hours
- No urine within 24 hours
- Blue lips or skin

Quick Summary

Time	Do This	Avoid This
0–2 hrs	Skin-to-skin + first feed	Powder / oil
2–6 hrs	Keep cord dry, feed every 2h	Touching the stump
6–12 hrs	Cap, mittens, cotton wipes	Wet wipes
12–24 hrs	Sponge bath, jaundice check	Full bath or water

Chapter 2 · Month 1 (0–30 Days) · Adjustment

Feeding

- Only breast milk or formula — nothing else
- Feed every 2–3 hours (8–12 times/day)
- Never give water, honey, or glucose water

What to Apply / Care

- Keep umbilical stump dry — falls off in 7–15 days
- First 2–3 weeks: cotton + water only (no soap)
- Thin zinc oxide layer for diaper rash
- Start oil massage after 2–3 weeks (patch test first)

Sleep 16–18 hrs (wake for feeds)	Milestones Eyes focus, reacts to sound, slight neck control

Activity idea: Skin-to-skin contact and soft lullabies

Check jaundice — see doctor if yellow tint lasts >24 hrs

Chapter 3 · Month 2 · The Smile Month

Feeding

- Only milk — pattern settles to ~every 3 hours
- Mother’s diet can affect milk taste

What to Apply / Care

- Start mild baby soap on alternate days
- Cradle cap: coconut oil 15 min then soft brush
- Keep nails short (babies scratch themselves)

Sleep 15–16 hrs (night feeds still needed)	Milestones Social smile appears! Cooing sounds begin

Activity idea: Tummy time 2–3 minutes daily

Excessive crying or feeding refusal consult doctor

Chapter 4 · Month 3 · Communication

Feeding

- Only milk — intervals stretch to 3–4 hours
- Formula babies may take 90–120 ml per feed

What to Apply / Care

- Daily gentle massage (afternoon preferred)
- Fragrance-free lotion only if skin is dry

Sleep 14–16 hrs (some sleep 5–6 hrs at night)	Milestones Opens/closes hands, turns to sound, first laughter

Activity idea: Colorful toys at 20–30 cm for eye tracking

Poor head control or crossed eyes get checked

Chapter 5 · Month 4 · Rolling Over

Feeding

- Only milk — baby may get distracted while feeding
- Feed in a quiet room if needed

What to Apply / Care

- Teething may start — offer sterilized silicone teether
- Trim nails weekly

Sleep	Milestones
14–15 hrs (sleep regression common)	Rolls over! Never leave alone on bed or sofa

Activity idea: Increase tummy time to 10 min, copy sounds

Start baby-proofing the house now

Chapter 6 · Month 5 · Grasping

Feeding

- Only milk — schedule more regular
- Ask doctor about iron drops

What to Apply / Care

- No teething gel without advice — teether + massage enough
- Hair oil max twice a week

Sleep 14 hrs · 2–3 naps	Milestones Grasps objects, brings feet to mouth, stranger anxiety

Activity idea: Rattles, high-fives, hand clapping games

Weight not increasing or excessive crying doctor

Chapter 7 · Month 6 · Solids Begin!

Feeding

- First solid: rice cereal or lentil water — 1–2 spoons after milk
- 3-day rule: one new food for 3 days to check allergy
- Safe: mashed banana, apple, carrot, rice, moong dal water
- Avoid: honey, cow's milk, salt, sugar, whole nuts, citrus

What to Apply / Care

- Finger brush with water only if teeth appearing
- Wipe face often during meals

Sleep 14 hrs · 2 naps	Milestones Sits with support, responds to name, babbling

Activity idea: Supported sitting practice, introduce tastes slowly

6-month vaccines + iron/calcium check recommended

Chapter 8 · Month 7 · Real Food Taste

Feeding

- 2 meals + milk
- Khichdi, banana, apple, unsweetened semolina porridge
- Egg yolk possible (if not vegetarian) — 3-day rule
- Water 50–100 ml/day from a cup

What to Apply / Care

- Daily finger brush with water
- Weekly nail care

Sleep 13–14 hrs · 2 naps	Milestones Sits without support, transfers objects, mama/papa sounds

Activity idea: Pull toys, clapping games

Chapter 9 · Month 8 · Crawling

Feeding

- 2–3 meals + milk
- Finger foods: steamed carrot sticks, banana pieces
- Wheat porridge, dalia, curd (great for digestion)

What to Apply / Care

- SPF 30+ baby sunscreen when outdoors
- Prefer mosquito net / full sleeves over chemical sprays

Sleep 13–14 hrs (naps may drop to 1)	Milestones Crawling starts! Baby-proof sockets, floor, sharp corners

Activity idea: Name objects, stacking cups, “Where is the ball?”

Chapter 10 · Month 9 · Standing Ready

Feeding

- 3 meals + milk (family food without chili/salt)
- Soft roti pieces and crumbled paneer okay

What to Apply / Care

- Brush twice daily — rice-grain fluoride toothpaste (ask doctor)
- Hair wash twice a week

Sleep 13–14 hrs · 1–2 naps	Milestones Stands holding furniture, waves bye-bye, looks for hidden toys

Activity idea: Avoid baby walkers — allow furniture cruising or push toys

Chapter 11 · Month 10 · First Steps

Feeding

- 3 meals + 1 snack + milk
- Most home-cooked food okay with light seasoning
- Still no cow’s milk until 12 months

What to Apply / Care

- Brush after night feed (milk sugar causes decay)
- Black spots on teeth pediatric dentist

Sleep	Milestones
12–14 hrs · one nap settling	Cruising sideways, first meaningful words

Activity idea: Throw ball, name objects, show flowers

Chapter 12 · Month 11 · Walking Practice

Feeding

- 3 meals + 2 snacks + milk
- Full egg can be introduced
- Still avoid whole nuts, popcorn, chips, honey, juice

What to Apply / Care

- 4–8 teeth common — brushing twice daily non-negotiable
- Trim toenails too

Sleep 12–13 hrs · 1 afternoon nap	Milestones Walks with one-hand support, independent sit/stand

Activity idea: Simple instructions, stacking rings

Chapter 13 · Month 12 · Happy Birthday!

Feeding

- Cow’s milk can start (max 300–400 ml/day)
- 3 meals + 2 snacks — seat at family table
- Birthday treat: a few spoons only — avoid sugar habit

What to Apply / Care

- Brush twice daily with fluoride toothpaste
- Daily sunscreen outdoors
- Full daily bath is fine

Sleep 12–13 hrs · solid night sleep + 1 nap	Milestones Walking! (normal range 9–16 months), 2–3 words, tries spoon

Activity idea: Dance to rhymes, ball games, picture books

Chapter 14 · Vaccination Chart

Based on standard immunization schedules. Always confirm with your pediatrician — recommendations can vary by country and individual needs.

Age	Vaccines	Notes
At Birth	BCG, Hep B (birth), OPV-0	Usually in hospital
6 Weeks	DTwP/DTaP-1, IPV-1, Hep B-2, Hib-1, Rota-1, PCV-1	First major set
10 Weeks	DTwP/DTaP-2, IPV-2, Hib-2, Rota-2, PCV-2	
14 Weeks	DTwP/DTaP-3, IPV-3, Hib-3, Rota-3, PCV-3	
6 Months	Influenza-1 (optional), Hep B-3	
9 Months	MMR-1, Typhoid Conjugate	
12 Months	Hepatitis A-1	

Parent Tip

- Keep baby well-rested and lightly fed on vaccine day
- Mild fever is common — use paracetamol only as advised by doctor
- Cool cloth on injection site can comfort the baby

Chapter 15 · Red Flags — When to Call the Doctor

Seek medical help immediately if you notice any of these signs. Do not wait.

Breathing Difficulty — Fast breathing, wheezing, chest pulling in, blue lips

High Fever — 100.4°F (38°C) or higher in a baby under 3 months

Feeding Refusal — Nothing eaten or drunk for 8–12 hours

Forceful / Green Vomit — Projectile vomiting or green/bloody vomit

Dehydration — Dry lips, sunken eyes, no urine 6+ hours, sunken soft spot

Seizures — Body jerks, eyes rolling, loss of consciousness

Worsening Jaundice — Yellow color spreading + baby becoming lethargic

Umbilical Infection — Pus, redness, foul smell, or fever around cord

Inconsolable Crying — Crying hard for 3+ hours, hard abdomen

Head Injury / Fall — Vomiting, drowsiness, or eye changes after a fall

Keep These Numbers Ready

- Local emergency / ambulance number
- Your pediatrician + nearest hospital
- Poison control (India: 1800-116-117)

Chapter 16 · Bonus Printable Checklists

Print these pages and keep them handy for daily tracking.

1. Feeding Tracker (One Day)

Time	Type	Amount / Duration	Notes
___:___	Breast Formula	_____	
___:___	Breast Formula	_____	
___:___	Breast Formula	_____	
___:___	Breast Formula	_____	
___:___	Breast Formula	_____	
___:___	Breast Formula	_____	

2. Newborn Shopping Checklist

Clothes (bodysuits, sleepsuits, caps, mittens, socks) — 6–8 sets
Newborn diapers + cotton / wipes
Blankets / swaddles — 2–3
Digital thermometer
Nail clipper + mild soap & shampoo
Zinc oxide cream + massage oil
Car seat + stroller / carrier
Bottles + sterilizer (if formula feeding)

3. Sleep Log (One Week)

Day	Night Sleep	Nap 1	Nap 2	Total
Mon	___ hrs	___	___	___
Tue	___ hrs	___	___	___
Wed	___ hrs	___	___	___
Thu	___ hrs	___	___	___
Fri	___ hrs	___	___	___
Sat	___ hrs	___	___	___
Sun	___ hrs	___	___	___

4. Vaccination Reminder

- Birth: BCG, Hep B, OPV-0 — Date: _____
- 6 Weeks: _____
- 10 Weeks: _____
- 14 Weeks: _____
- 6 Months: _____
- 9 Months: _____
- 12 Months: _____

5. Emergency Contact Card

- Pediatrician: _____ Phone: _____
- Nearest Hospital: _____ Phone: _____
- Ambulance / Emergency: _____
- Parent alternate number: _____
- Family emergency contact: _____
- Baby's blood group: _____ Allergies: _____

3 Things to Remember Every Month

1. Follow the vaccination schedule — never skip doses
2. Monitor weight monthly — see doctor if not increasing
3. Use the 3-day rule for every new food — stop if rash, vomiting or loose stools appear

With CuddleNine

Little Care, Big Love

May your baby's first year be safe, happy and full of love.
Every baby is unique — this guide is a starting point. Always follow your doctor's advice.

© CuddleNine · Educational guide only · Not a substitute for professional medical advice